

Unit: English Culture: Graded Readers & Stereotypes

詳細內容雙語對照 / Detailed Bilingual Content

Unit Introduction / 單元導言

This unit has two sections. First, I would like to introduce a 'graded reader' to you, which is composed of short stories about English culture. Then, we want to learn about English / British culture in more depth.

本單元有兩個部分。首先，我想向您介紹一種「分級讀物」，它由關於英國文化的短篇故事組成。然後，我們想更深入地了解英國/不列顛文化。

1. Some people would argue that British food is terrible, but I couldn't disagree more. You should definitely try the traditional pies, pudding, fish & chips, bangers & mash, Sunday roast, and English breakfast, except the Christmas pudding.

1. 有些人會認為英國的食物很難吃，但我完全不同意。你絕對應該嘗試傳統的派、布丁、炸魚薯條、香腸土豆泥、週日烤肉和英式早餐，除了聖誕布丁。

2. The British have the habit of queuing and it is considered taboo that someone jumps the queue, so make sure to wait for your turn.

2. 英國人有排隊的習慣，插隊被視為禁忌，所以請務必耐心等待輪到你。

What are Graded Readers? / 什麼是分級讀物？

In the previous units, we have learned about extensive reading, speed and level of reading, and material choosing, such as picture books and young adult novels for language learning. In this unit, the last type of material that I would like to encourage you to read in this course is 'graded readers'.

在先前的單元中，我們學習了泛讀、閱讀速度和水準，以及語言學習的材料選擇（例如繪本和青少年小說）。在本單元中，我希望鼓勵您在此課程中閱讀的最後一種材料類型是「分級讀物（graded readers）」。

We now know that extensive reading aims to ask the learners to read in large quantities at the learner's level. We mentioned that ideally there should be only around two unfamiliar words out of every 100 running words. In practice, learners neither know their own vocabulary size nor have the ability to judge the level of text difficulty if they are not advanced learners. To respond to these issues, many publishers have created 'graded readers', which are specifically written to be at the right level of vocabulary and at the appropriate length for learners. Usually, graded readers are produced in series. According to The Extensive Reading Foundation:

我們現在知道，泛讀旨在要求學習者在適合其水準的基礎上進行大量閱讀。我們提到，理想情況下，每100個連續字詞中應該只有大約兩個陌生字詞。在實踐中，除非是高階學習者，否則學習者既不知道自己的詞彙量，也沒有能力判斷文本難易度。為了應對這些問題，許多出版社創建了「分級讀物」，這些讀物是專門為學習者量身定做的合適詞彙水準和長度。通常，分級讀物是成系列出版的。根據泛讀基金會的說法：

"Graded Readers are books of various genres that are specially created for learners of foreign languages. They may be simplified versions of existing works, original stories or books that are factual in nature. They are 'graded' in the sense that the syntax and lexis are controlled in order to make the content accessible to learners of the language. Publishers normally issue reader series with 4-6 different reading levels to suit a range of skill levels and allow progress over time. The Extensive Reading Foundation also refers to graded readers as Language Learner Literature (LLL), indicating that they comprise a valid, 'authentic' type of literature aimed at a specific readership."

「分級讀物是專門為外語學習者創作的各種流派的書籍。它們可能是現有作品的簡化版本、原創故事或紀實性質的書籍。它們之所以被稱為『分級』，是因為其句法和詞彙都受到了控制，以便該語言的學習者能夠理解其內容。出版社通常會發行具有 4 到 6 個不同閱讀水準的讀物系列，以適應不同的技能水準並允許隨著時間的推移取得進步。泛讀基金會也將分級讀物稱為語言學習者文學 (LLL)，表明它們構成了一種針對特定讀者群的有效且『真實』的文學類型。」

Most major publishers have at least one and often several series of graded readers (Nation, 2013). My personal favorite in teaching is Cambridge English Readers which are original stories written specifically at different vocabulary levels and so far there is no Chinese translation available yet. Nation (2013) also used Cambridge English Reader as an example to introduce the idea using graded readers in extensive reading programs.

大多數主要出版社都至少有一個、通常是幾套分級讀物系列 (Nation, 2013)。我個人在教學中最喜歡的是《劍橋英語讀物》(Cambridge English Readers)，這些是專門為不同詞彙水準編寫的原創故事，目前還沒有中文譯本。Nation (2013) 也以劍橋英語讀物為例，介紹了在泛讀計畫中使用分級讀物的概念。

Cambridge English Readers Level Equivalence (Nation, 2013) / 分級讀物水準對照表

Level 1: 400 unique words | Approx. 4,000 words length | Example: Bad love, Blood diamonds

第一級：400個不同字詞 | 約 4,000 字長度 | 範例：《糟糕的愛》、《血鑽石》

Level 2: 800 unique words | Approx. 10,000 words length | Example: Apollo's gold, Jojo's story

第二級：800個不同字詞 | 約 10,000 字長度 | 範例：《阿波羅的金子》、《喬喬的故事》

Level 3: 1,300 unique words | Approx. 15,000 words length | Example: The Beast, Two lives

第三級：1,300個不同字詞 | 約 15,000 字長度 | 範例：《野獸》、《兩個生命》

Level 4: 1,900 unique words | Approx. 20,000 words length | Example: Berlin express, Staying together

第四級：1,900個不同字詞 | 約 20,000 字長度 | 範例：《柏林快車》、《在一起》

Level 5: 2,800 unique words | Approx. 25,000 words length | Example: All I want, Tangled web

第五級：2,800個不同字詞 | 約 25,000 字長度 | 範例：《我所想要的一切》、《錯綜複雜的網》

Level 6: 3,800 unique words | Approx. 30,000 words length | Example: A love for life, Murder maker

第六級：3,800個不同字詞 | 約 30,000 字長度 | 範例：《一生的愛》、《謀殺製造者》

For example, in level 3 of the series, all of the books are well-designed and written within the vocabulary of 1,300 words, so if you are around this level, you will be able to read the books at this level without difficulty. Therefore, a level-1 or level-2 learner will find it hard to read a level-3 book due to the unfamiliar words in the texts. These books are designed to be quite long, because this gives learners opportunities to practice reading at the appropriate level for them. While the readers read these interesting, exciting, or at least new stories, they recall some words they have learned before, retrieve words from memory, and see different forms of the same word in a variety of sentences or contexts.

例如，在該系列的第三級中，所有的書都設計得很好，並且是在 1,300 個單字的詞彙量範圍內編寫的，因此如果您大約處於這個水準，您將能夠毫無困難地閱讀這個水準的書籍。因此，由於文本中存在不熟悉的字詞，第一級或第二級的學習者會發現很難閱讀第三級的書。這些書設計得相當長，因為這給了學習者在適合他們的水準上練習閱讀的機會。當讀者閱讀這些有趣、刺激或至少是新的故事時，他們會回想起以前學過的一些單字，從記憶中檢索單字，並在各種句子或語境中看到同一個單字的不同形式。

The book which I think suits this course purpose is from Cambridge English Readers 6. The book title is 'Frozen Pizza and other slices of life'. The author is Antoinette Moses and it introduces life in modern England through eight stories, which is the eight 'slices of life' following the metaphor of Frozen Pizza in the title. These eight short stories covered themes of food, media, immigration, student life, football hooliganism, inner-city problems, leisure activities and the country side of life in England. While you read the stories, you can also learn about life in modern England. People usually have certain stereotypes of the English people or culture, for instance, English people are indifferent and have a strange sense of humor. However, I find them friendly and warm. We all know that stereotypes could be wrong because stereotypes are often over-simplified or over-generalized images towards a certain group of people or issue. It is not a terrible crime to have stereotypes, but, at least, what we can do is try to get to know and understand them first, then make the judgment by ourselves as a way to show our respect towards other cultures.

我認為適合本課程目的書是劍橋英語讀物第六級的。書名是《冷凍披薩與人生的其他切片》。作者是安托瓦內特·摩西 (Antoinette Moses)，它通過八個故事介紹了現代英格蘭的生活，這八個故事是繼書名中冷凍披薩的比喻之後的八個「人生切片」。這八個短篇故事涵蓋了英國生活的食物、媒體、移民、學生生活、足球流氓、市中心問題、休閒活動和鄉村等主題。在閱讀故事的同時，您還可以了解現代英格蘭的生活。人們通常對英國人或英國文化有一些刻板印象，例如，英國人冷漠且

有著奇怪的幽默感。然而，我發現他們很友好和熱情。我們都知道刻板印象可能是錯誤的，因為刻板印象往往是對特定人群或問題過於簡化或過於籠統的印象。有刻板印象並不是可怕的罪行，但至少我們可以做的是嘗試先去認識和理解他們，然後自己做出判斷，以展示我們對其他文化的尊重。

Stereotypes of English Culture / 英國文化的刻板印象

1. British people love talking about weather / 1. 英國人熱愛談論天氣

It is possibly the most spoken of the topic in the country. On the one hand, there is never a dull moment when it comes to the British weather since it is changeable and famously unpredictable. On the other hand, weather talk is an icebreaker, and it is used to fill awkward silences or divert the conversation away from uncomfortable topics, such as salary or age.

這可能是該國被談論最多的話題。一方面，就英國天氣而言，從來沒有無聊的時刻，因為它多變且以不可預測而聞名。另一方面，天氣談話是打破僵局的工具，它被用來填補尷尬的沉默，或將對話從令人不適的話題（如薪水或年齡）中轉移開。

According to social anthropologist Kate Fox, there are certain unwritten rules that the British follow when having these weather-related conversations. Firstly, the topic will always be introduced as a form of question, even if only in the intonation (e.g., "Raining again?"). Secondly, the person answering must agree. "Failing to agree is quite a serious breach of etiquette. Or at least if you disagree, you have to express it in terms of a sort of personal foible". "If someone says: 'Cold, isn't it?' and you say: 'Well actually, no,' the person would be a bit taken aback, and feel that that was a discourteous thing to say."

根據社會人類學家凱特·福克斯（Kate Fox）的說法，英國人在進行這些與天氣相關的對話時遵循某些不成文的規則。首先，這個話題總是會以問題的形式引入，即使只是在語調上（例如，「又下雨了？」）。其次，回答的人必須同意。「不表示同意是相當嚴重的失禮行為。或者至少如果你不同意，你也必須將其表達為一種個人怪癖。」「如果有人說：『很冷，不是嗎？』而你說：『嗯，其實沒有，』那個人會有點吃驚，並覺得那是一句粗魯無禮的話。」

2. British people always complain but also are polite / 2. 英國人總是抱怨，但也很禮貌

British people love grumbling to each other about everything from neighbours to politicians, from energy bills to noisy parties and from the weather being too cold to the weather being too hot, but they also say "sorry", "please" and "thank you" a lot. However, there are equally as many positive British people as there are negative ones, it completely depends on the person you talk to.

英國人喜歡互相抱怨一切，從鄰居到政治家，從電費單到吵鬧的派對，從天氣太冷到天氣太熱，但他們也經常說「對不起」、「請」和「謝謝」。然而，積極的英國人與消極的英國人一樣多，這完全取決於你與之交談的人。

Example: British people in a restaurant. When the waitress comes round to do her check and says: "how is everything?" and they respond with: "oh it's lovely thank you" after secretly complaining for the last 10 minutes that the food is cold.

範例：餐館裡的英國人。當女服務員過來詢問「一切都好嗎？」時，他們回答：「噢，非常好，謝謝你」，而在此之前的10分鐘裡，他們一直在私下抱怨食物是冷冰冰的。

3. British people have a stiff upper lip / 3. 英國人保持堅忍克己 (Stiff Upper Lip)

This term comes from the idea that an emotional or upset person has a quivering upper lip, so a stiff upper lip refers to the concept that the British are quite reserved and keep their emotions and feelings to themselves. This stems from the Victorian period, when showing your emotions was indeed considered inappropriate to show their self-restraint. Whilst the times are changing and a number of newspaper articles in recent years have argued that the British stiff upper lip no more, for instance, the public outpouring of emotion at the death of Diana, Princess of Wales.

這個詞來自於這樣一個觀點：一個情緒激動或沮喪的人會有顫抖的上唇，因此「硬上唇 (stiff upper lip)」指的是英國人相當保守，將自己的情緒和感受隱藏起來的概念。這源於維多利亞時代，當時展示你的情緒確實被認為是不合適的，應該展示自我克制。雖然時代在變，近年來一些報紙文章也爭辯說英國人的堅忍克己已不復存在，例如威爾斯王妃黛安娜去世時公眾情緒的宣洩。

4. British people love drinking tea / 4. 英國人熱愛喝茶

Tea is definitely a key part of British culture. From early morning to late at night, the kettle is on for a brew in many households across the country, and making tea for other people is the ultimate form of British hospitality. Milk in tea plays an important role while some taking their tea with sugar or lemon instead; however, more than the taste, milk in tea also gives off cues to Britain's social class system.

茶絕對是英國文化的核心部分。從清晨到深夜，全國許多家庭都在燒水泡茶，為他人沏茶是英式熱情好客的終極形式。茶中的牛奶起著重要作用，而有些人則用糖或檸檬代替；然而，除了口味之外，茶中的牛奶也發出了英國社會階級系統的信號。

According to Fox, tea strength wanes as the social class gets nearer to the aristocracy. The strongest brews of black tea are drunk by the working class, who are then required to temper the bitter taste with plenty of milk and sugar to make "builder's tea." "Taking sugar in your tea is regarded by many as an infallible lower-class indicator".

根據福克斯的說法，隨著社會階級接近貴族，茶的濃度會減弱。最強烈的黑茶是由工人階級喝的，然後他們需要加入大量的牛奶和糖來緩和苦味，製成「建築工人之茶 (builder's tea)」。許多人將「在茶中加糖」視為工人階級無可爭議的指標。

Extended Content / 延伸內容

YouTube Video: British Stereotypes. In this video, some of the British stereotypes were asked to Britons, and they talked about their point of view. Issues covered: politeness, humour, tea, lack of emotion, teeth, food, monolingualism and anti-social behavior abroad. (video length: 13 minutes 25 seconds)

YouTube 影片《英國人的刻板印象》：在這段影片中，一些關於英國人的刻板印象被向英國人提出，他們談論了自己的觀點。涵蓋的問題包括：禮貌、幽默、茶、缺乏情感、牙齒、食物、單一語言和在國外的反社會行為。